

Phishing Awareness Training

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship



Presented by: Gokul V
Student ID: CA/DF1/312305



UNDERSTANDING PHISHING: A COMMON CYBER THREAT

1. THE DECEPTION (IMPERSONATION)



Attackers impersonate
trusted entities

2. THE TRAP



3. THE THEFT (SENSITIVE DATA)

- PASSWORDS



- CREDIT CARD
NUMBERS



- PERSONAL
DATA



- LOGIN
CREDENTIALS



THE PHISHING LIFECYCLE: HOW ATTACKS WORK



1. Attacker Sends Fake Message

Emails or messages are sent to targets.



2. Victim Clicks Link/Attachment

The recipient interacts with malicious content.



3. Lands on Fake Site/Installs Malware

Sensitive information is entered, or malware is downloaded.



4. Attacker Steals Credentials/Data

Personal and financial data is captured.



5. Uses Stolen Info for Fraud

Identity theft, unauthorized access, or ransomware attacks.

TYPES OF PHISHING ATTACKS

1. EMAIL PHISHING



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Email Phishing — mass emails to many targets.

2. SPEAR PHISHING



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Spear Phishing — targeted at a specific person.

3. WHALING



3. WHALING

Whaling — targeting executives/CEO.

4. SMISHING



4. SMISHING

Smishing — SMS-based phishing.

5. VISHING



5. VISHING

Vishing — voice call phishing.

6. CLONE



6. CLONE PHISHING

Clone Phishing — copy of a real email with malicious link.

COMMON PHISHING RED FLAGS

Be on the lookout for these warning signs.



Countdown time tinpet

"Act Now!"

Countdown 00:49:20

Creating panic to force rash decisions.

 **Urgent or Threatening Language**

Creating text Snippet :
Hover to preview the actual destination URL.



"Dear valved costumer..."

Poor language as of fraud.

 **Spelling and Grammar Mistakes**

Poor language is a classic sign of fraud.



official.domain.com
vs.
support@paypa1.com

Email addresses that almost look real.

 **Unexpected Attachments**

Opening unsolicited files can download malware.



Click Here

<https://malicious-site.tk/>

<https://malicioioi.>

Password

Credit Card Number

CVV

 **Requests for Passwords or Payment Info**

Legitimate companies rarely ask for this via email.



DEAR CUSTOMER

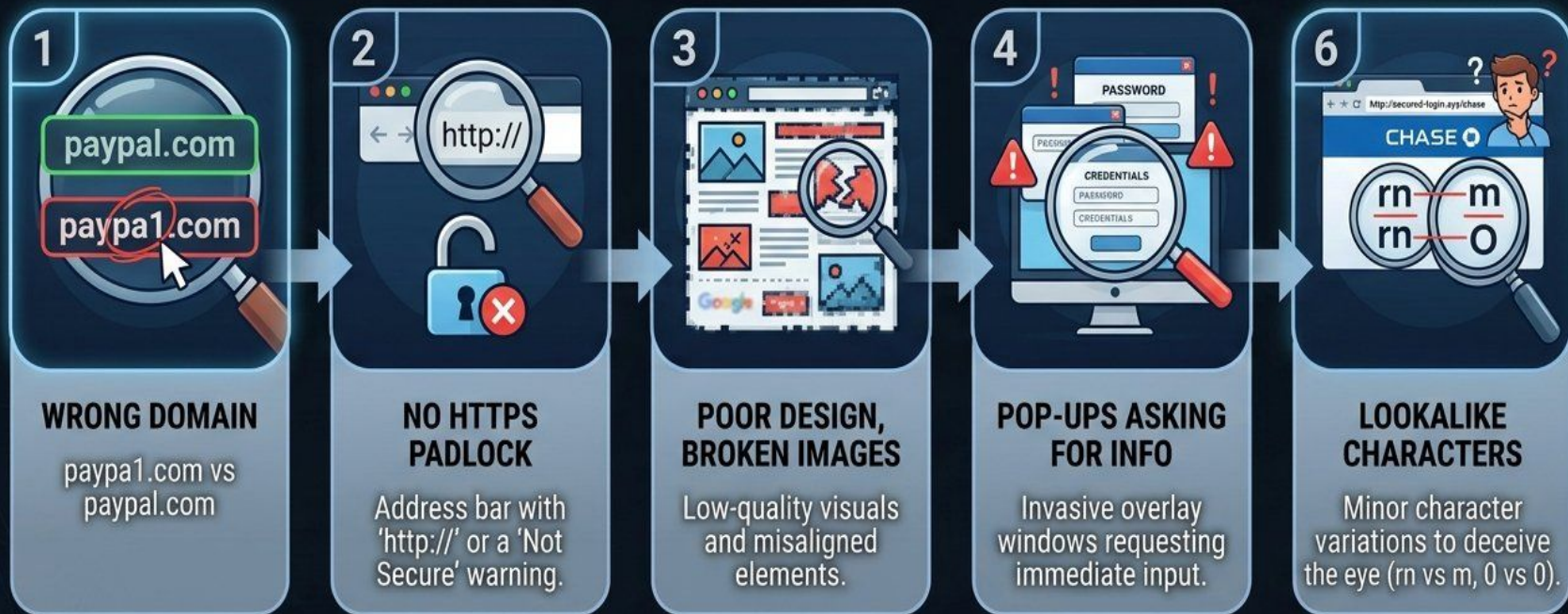
Generic Greetings

"Dear Customer..."

Lack of personalization indicate a mass attack.

IDENTIFYING FAKE WEBSITES: RED FLAGS

Be vigilant before you interact.



ATTACKERS EXPLOIT HUMAN EMOTIONS

Be aware of how phishers use your feelings against you.



2016 GOOGLE/FACEBOOK PHISHING SCAM

A case study in high-value attacker impersonation.

THE ATTACK



IMPERSONATION

Attacker posed as a hardware vendor (e.g., Quanta Computer).



Built a relationship, then sent large, fake invoices to target accounts.

THE INVOICES



FAKE INVOICES

Google & Facebook employees received and approved payment for over \$100 Million.



The fraud was possible because internal verification processes were bypassed or lacking.

THE DISCOVERY & RECOVERY



SCAM DETECTED

The fraud was discovered through internal audits and investigations.



Both companies eventually recovered the entire stolen sum.

THE LESSON

- Even global tech giants can be tricked.
- Scams can bypass sophisticated internal controls.
- Always verify and validate payment requests, especially large ones.



BUILD YOUR DIGITAL DEFENSE: THE 8 GOLDEN RULES

Practical steps to protect yourself against common cyber threats.

1.



1. VERIFY SENDER EMAIL

Check full sender address, not just display name.

Before clicking any link.

2.



2. HOVER OVER LINKS

See true URL. Don't fall for fake login pages.

Never enter credentials on unfamiliar sites.

3.



3. ENABLE MFA (Multi-Factor)

Add an essential second layer of protection.

Turn it on for all accounts where available.

4.



4. AVOID UNEXPECTED ATTACHMENTS

Do not open files from unknown sources.

Macros can be dangerous.

5.



5. TYPE URLS MANUALLY

Navigate to official sites directly. Don't click link.

Type the known URL for important sites.

6.

REPORT SUSPICIOUS EMAILS



7. KEEP SOFTWARE UPDATED

Report to IT/Security immediately.

Generate long and complex passwords.

TEST YOUR KNOWLEDGE!



[https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLScPH7qkV3avK3nG01T_ZTePn1AmfakRqjjV0VlpyKAP54at8w/viewform]

Access the quiz via the link to test your security awareness.

THANK YOU!
STAY ALERT. STAY SAFE.



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#CyberSecurity



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